

DANIELLE SCHMIDT-LARIOS

University of Wisconsin – Madison, Community & Environmental Sociology
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EDUCATION

- Exp. 2027 PhD, Sociology/Community & Environmental Sociology, University of Wisconsin-Madison
Dissertation: Spatiotemporalities of Agricultural Land Loss
Committee: Katherine J. Curtis (chair) – Community & Environmental Sociology
Sarah Rios (hon. co-chair) – Environmental Studies, Cal Poly Humboldt
Samer Alatout – Community & Environmental Sociology
Tessa Conroy – Ag & Applied Economics/Extension Specialist
Nan Enstad – Community & Environmental Sociology
Amanda McMillan Lequieu – Sociology, Drexel University
Prelim. Exams: Environmental Sociology (passed with distinction)
Sociology of Agrifood Systems
Minor: Geography
- 2023 MS, Community & Environmental Sociology, University of Wisconsin-Madison
Thesis: Towards an Emplaced Vocabulary of Motive: Understanding the
decision-making processes of agricultural landholders in the Upper
Missouri River Breaks
- 2019 AB, Philosophy, Public Policy Studies (honors), The University of Chicago
Minor: Human Rights

PUBLICATIONS*

- Boyce, McKenzie, Yang Cheng, Erin Gaede, and **Danielle Schmidt-Larios**. [Forthcoming]. “Measuring Rural Livability: Challenges, Choices, and Considerations.” In *Redefining Community Development Through Rural Livability*, edited by Tessa Conroy and Steven Deller. Community Development Series, Routledge.
- Schmidt-Larios, Danielle**. 2026. “Land through three approaches.” *Agriculture and Human Values*, 43(35). <https://doi.org/10.1007/s10460-026-10853-1>.
- Schmidt, Danielle**, Tessa Conroy, and Steven Deller. 2025. “Prosperity Across the United States: Revisiting the Isserman, Feser, and Warren Prosperity Index Using Sequence Analysis.” *International Regional Science Review* 49(2): 147–78. <https://doi.org/10.1177/01600176251377424>.
*winner of the Ron Wimberly Award from the Rural Sociological Society
- Schmidt, Danielle**. 2024. “Towards an Emplaced Vocabulary of Motive: Senses of Place and Land Sale Decision-Making in the Northern Great Plains.” *Rural Sociology*, 89(4), 975-995.
<https://doi.org/10.1111/ruso.12574>.

* Published as “Danielle Schmidt” prior to 2026.

Schmidt, Danielle. 2023. "Farming for sociologists: A new key text for rural sociologists." *Journal of Agriculture, Food Systems, and Community Development*, 12(4), 1–2.
<https://doi.org/10.5304/jafscd.2023.124.004>

Schmidt, Danielle and Séamus A. Power. 2020. "Offline World: The Internet as Social Infrastructure among the Unconnected in Quasi-Rural Illinois." *Integrative Psychological and Behavioral Science*, 55(2), 371–385. <https://doi.org/10.1007/s12124-020-09574-9>.

MANUSCRIPTS IN PROGRESS

Under review

Boyce, Mckenzie, **Danielle Schmidt-Larios**, Erin Gaede, and Yang Cheng. "The Community Capitals for Quantitative Research: Data, Directions, and Debates," *Journal of Rural Studies* [R&R]

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle and Katherine J. Curtis. "Leaving 'Cowboy Ethnography' in the Dust and Advancing the Practice of Collaborative Ethnography," *Sociological Methods and Research* [First submit, April 2026]

Boyce, Mckenzie, Tessa Conroy, and **Danielle Schmidt-Larios**. "A Fork in the Road: How Measurement Decisions Shape Narratives of Livability and Can Misrepresent Rural Places," *Annals of Regional Science* [First submit, August 2026]

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle, Amanda McMillan Lequieu, and Katherine J. Curtis. 2027. "Home in a Changing Climate." In *A Global Assessment of Sociology's Contributions to the Climate Emergency*, Routledge. [Invited by the International Sociological Association]

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle, Mckenzie Boyce, and Tessa Conroy. "Borrowing Natural Capital: Assessing the value of spatially shared natural amenities on local quality of life," *Economic Geography* [First submit, September 2026]

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle and Sarah Rios. "Wildfires in the Workplace: A Survey of Latinx Farmworkers," *Journal of Environmental Studies and Sciences* [First submit, September 2026]

In preparation

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle. "Former Farms: Quantifying, classifying, and assessing agricultural land loss in the post-Farm Crisis era," *Land Use Policy*

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle and Katherine J. Curtis. "To Lose One's Place: Confronting environmental and community change on the Northern Great Plains," *Rural Sociology*

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle and Sarah Rios. "The manufactured precarity of farm work," in *Handbook of Environmental Racism*, edited by Michael Mascarenhas, Julie Sze, Alex Huevo, Stephen Gasteyer, and Diana Ojeda. Anthem Press. [Abstract accepted/chapter invited]

Avila, Elisa, Katherine J. Curtis, and **Danielle Schmidt-Larios**. "Place-based Framework for in-depth interviews across the Rural-Urban Continuum," *Qualitative Inquiry*

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle. "Constructing the Myth of Wilderness, from Gilded Age to Gilded Age," *Environmental History*

Book Manuscript

Schmidt-Larios, Danielle. *Reserved for whom? (Re)Making Home, Place, and Identity on Rural Landscapes* [Proposal in preparation]

OUTREACH & PUBLIC SCHOLARSHIP

- Schmidt-Larios, Danielle**, McKenzie Boyce, Tessa Conroy, and Steven Deller. 2026. *WIndicator: Sharing Livability: Assessing the Link Between Rural and Urban Prosperity* [Technical report]. University of Wisconsin–Madison Division of Extension. <https://doi.org/10.21231/mwem-5533>
- Schmidt, Danielle**, Tessa Conroy, and Steven Deller. 2025. “Pathways to Prosperity: Moving Beyond Growth to Evaluate Change in Community Well-Being.” *Choices Magazine* 40 (2). <https://www.choicesmagazine.org/choices-magazine/submitted-articles/pathways-to-prosperity-moving-beyond-growth-to-evaluate-change-in-community-well-being> [peer reviewed]
- Schmidt, Danielle**, Tessa Conroy, and Steven Deller. 2025. *WIndicator: Understanding Wisconsin prosperity in the national context* [Technical report]. University of Wisconsin–Madison Division of Extension. <https://doi.org/10.21231/BRBW-6V80>
- Curtis, Katherine J., **Danielle D. Schmidt**, and John C. Canfield. “Views on the Land.” *Phillips County News*, May 22, 2024. <https://www.phillipscountynews.com/story/2024/05/22/opinion/views-on-the-land/15471.html>
- Rios, Sarah and **Danielle Schmidt**. 2023. “Survey Summary: A summary of farmworker responses to experiencing wildfires in the workplace.” Prepared for *Lideres Campesinas en California*. <https://liderescampesinas.org/wp-content/uploads/2024/10/F.I.R.E-Report-1030-.pdf>
- Schmidt, Danielle**. “Letter: Tyson the Bison and the Future of Farming.” *Daily Herald*, May 14, 2022. <https://www.dailyherald.com/discuss/20220514/letter-tyson-the-bison-and-the-future-of-farming>
- Curtis, Katherine J., John C. Canfield, and **Danielle D. Schmidt**. 2021. “A Report on Population and Ag Production in Phillips County, Montana.” <https://apl.wisc.edu/shared/conservation-agriculture-rural/phillips-county>

AWARDS & HONORS

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| May 2026 | John Harrison Kolb Memorial Scholarship Award for <i>exceptional intellectual contributions, academic achievements, and professional involvement</i> , Dept. of Community & Environmental Sociology, UW-Madison |
| Apr. 2026 | Calvin L. Beale Graduate Award for <i>perpetuating the belief that understanding the people behind the statistics is the very essence of sociological research</i> , Dept. of Sociology, UW-Madison |
| Mar. 2025 | Ronald Wimberley Graduate Student Paper Competition for <i>making a strong contribution to our understanding of rural community life and health</i> , Community, Health, and Family Research Interest Group, Rural Sociological Society |
| Nov. 2023 | Honored Instructor for <i>positive impact on students</i> , University Housing (student nominated), UW-Madison |
| Jun. 2019 | Richard P. Taub Prize for <i>best thesis</i> , Dept. of Public Policy, The University of Chicago |
| Nov. 2018 | Abraham Lincoln Civic Engagement Award for <i>leadership and service in the pursuit of the betterment of humanity</i> , UChicago Recipient, The Lincoln Academy of Illinois |

COMPETITIVE RESEARCH FUNDING

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| May 2026 | Grad Student “Small Grant” Competition, Dept. of Sociology, UW-Madison, \$390 |
| May 2025 | Summer Mini-Grant, Center for Integrated Agricultural Systems (CIAS), \$2,991.80 |

May 2025	Graduate Student Grant, North-Central Region SARE, <i>not funded</i>
Mar. 2025	Dissertation Research Award, Rural Sociological Society, \$2,800
Oct. 2024	Predoctoral Fellowship, USDA NIFA AFRI, <i>not funded</i>
May 2024	Evelyn T. Crowe Scholarship – Pre-Dissertation Research, Dept. of Community & Environmental Sociology, UW-Madison, \$2,585
May 2022	Evelyn T. Crowe Scholarship – Master’s Thesis Research, Dept. of Community & Environmental Sociology, UW-Madison, \$5,000
Mar. 2022	Grad Student “Small Grant” Competition, Dept. of Sociology, UW-Madison, \$165

RESEARCH POSITIONS

Appointments

2024 -	Graduate Research Assistant, UW-Madison Agriculture & Applied Economics Wisconsin Rural Partnership Initiative: The Rural Livability Project Professor Tessa Conroy, Primary Investigator
2021-23	Graduate Research Assistant, UW-Madison Community & Environmental Sociology Crisis and Adaptation: How Wildfires Change the Agricultural Workplace Professor Sarah M. Rios, Primary Investigator
2020-21	State Research Assistantship, UW-Madison Community & Environmental Sociology Conflict at the Intersection of Production and Conservation Professor Katherine J. Curtis, Supervisor

Contracts

Spring 2026	GIS data visualization, Economic impact of hospitals on the Wisconsin economy Professor Steven Deller (Emeritus, UW-Madison)
Spring 2025	Qualitative data collection, Rural Informal Work in economically, socially, culturally, and technologically changing contexts Professor Emily Wornell (Ball State), Primary Investigator; Professors Amanda McMillan Lequieu (Drexel) and Jean Hardy (Michigan State), Supervisors

TEACHING POSITIONS

Appointments

Fall 2023	TA, SOC 125: <i>American Society: How It Really Works</i> , UW-Madison Dept of Sociology 37 students; 4.86/5 mean overall student evaluation (department mean 4.45/5)
Spring 2023	TA, ILS 200: <i>Critical Thinking & Expression</i> , UW-Madison Integrated Liberal Studies 34 students; mode score 5/5 across all student evaluation questions

Service & Mentorship

2026 -	Supervisor, Undergraduate Research Assistant for the Rural Livability Project
2025-26	Capstone Project “Expert,” Dept. of Agriculture and Applied Economics, UW-Madison
2024-25	ESL Instructor (Adult Education), Madison International Partners
2024-26	Research Mentor, AP Capstone Research, Mentor Matching Engine

INVITED PRESENTATIONS

- Oct. 2026 “Reserved for whom?” *Environment, Natural Resources, and Society*, UW-Madison [Guest lecture]
- Sep. 2026 “Deep Mapping Change in Human-Land Relations on the Northern Great Plains,” Symposium of the National Endowment for the Humanities (NEH) Community Deep Mapping Institute (CDMI), held in Sumter, South Carolina
- Apr. 2026 “Reserved: The transition of production agricultural land to conservation reserves across two cases,” Michigan Technological University Dept. of Social Sciences
- Nov. 2025 “Reserved for whom?” *Conservation Biology*, Williams College [Guest lecture]
- Oct. 2025 “Reserved for whom?” *Environment, Natural Resources, and Society*, UW-Madison [Guest lecture]
- Oct. 2025 “Cowboy Ethnography: Challenges of and strategies for collaborative spatial data collection and community engaged methods in the twenty-first century,” American Philosophical Society International Symposium on the Future of Fieldwork, held in Philadelphia, PA ([view recording here](#))
- Jun. 2025 “What Makes a Place ‘Livable’?” Connecting Entrepreneurial Communities, held in Wisconsin Rapids, WI ([view presentation slides here](#))

CONFERENCE PRESENTATIONS

- Nov. 2026 “Constructing the Myth of the Wilderness: Examining the sociopolitical process of creating conservation reserves,” Social Science History Association; Atlanta, GA
- Aug. 2026 “Borrowing Natural Capital: Assessing the value of spatially shared natural amenities on local livability,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Raleigh, NC
- Aug. 2026 “Negotiating Salvation: Conflict in Conservation,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Raleigh, NC
- Nov. 2025 “Former Farms, Future Farming: Quantifying, classifying, and assessing agricultural land loss in the post-Farm Crisis era using remote sensing and administrative data,” North American Regional Science Council Annual Meeting; Denver, CO
- Jul. 2025 “Former Farms, Future Farming: Quantifying, classifying, and assessing agricultural land loss in the post-Farm Crisis era using remote sensing and administrative data,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Salt Lake City, UT
- Jul. 2025 “The Spatial Diffusion of Rural Livability Across the Urban-Rural Interface,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Salt Lake City, UT
- Jul. 2025 “To Lose One’s Place: Confronting environmental and community change on the Northern Great Plains,” International Sociological Association; Rabat, Morocco
- Mar. 2025 “The Spatial Diffusion of Rural Livability Across the Urban-Rural Interface,” American Association of Geographers; Detroit, MI
- Jul. 2024 “To Lose One’s Place: Confronting environmental and community change on the Northern Great Plains,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Madison, WI
- Nov. 2023 “Wildfires in the Workplace: Understanding the manufactured precarity of farm work in a changing climate,” Social Science History Association Annual Conference; Washington, D.C.

- Apr. 2023 “Pricing the Prairie: Large-Scale Conservation and Early-Stage Rural Gentrification in a Western Agricultural Community,” Population Assoc. of America; New Orleans, LA
- Nov. 2022 “A Done Deed: The Socially Contentious Decision to Sell Production Land,” Social Science History Association Annual Conference; Chicago, IL
- Jul. 2021 “‘Save the Cowboy’: Large-Scale Conservation and Early-Stage Rural Gentrification in a Western Agricultural Community,” Rural Sociological Society Annual Meeting; Virtual

PROFESSIONAL MEMBERSHIPS & AFFILIATIONS

Rural Sociological Society; Social Science History Association; American Association of Geographers

SERVICE TO DEPARTMENT & PROFESSION

- 2025-26 Member, Awards and Endowment Committee, Rural Sociological Society
- 2023-25 Co-Chair, Rural, Ag, and Environmental Network, Social Science History Association
- 2023 Organizing Committee, UW Agroecology Symposium: “Relationships for Change”
- 2022 Graduate Student Rep., Ethics Committee, Rural Sociological Society
- 2020-22 Member, Culture & Climate Committee, UW-Madison Sociology Grad Student Assoc.

REFeree EXPERIENCE

Journals: *Agriculture and Human Values*; *International Journal of Sociology of Agriculture and Food*;
Review of Regional Studies

Books: *Redefining Community Development Through Rural Livability*

Grants: Rural Sociological Society; North Central Sustainable Agriculture and Research Education

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Software: R, ArcGIS (Pro, StoryMaps), Qualtrics, NVivo

Languages: English (native), Spanish (limited working proficiency)

Certifications: (Farmer-oriented) Mental Health First Aid, UW-Madison Research Mentor Badge

REFERENCES

Katherine J. Curtis

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